TATENDA CHITANDA

AI Governance Specialist | AI Risk & Compliance | GRC Consultant

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI Governance and GRC professional with 10+ years of experience in regulatory compliance, risk management, and responsible AI adoption. Founder and CEO of SentraCore LLC, a cybersecurity and AI governance consultancy serving SMEs across the US and African markets. Holder of ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Auditor certification with applied expertise in NIST AI RMF, ISO/IEC 42001:2023, and EU AI Act compliance requirements. Author of eight published articles on AI governance, SME cybersecurity compliance, and dual-use AI risk, with research cited by practitioners and academics globally. Built and deployed a working integrated AI governance management system combining ISO 27001, ISO 42001, NIST AI RMF, and POPIA, and developed a production AI risk register and model card platform as part of the SentraCore enterprise platform. Seeking AI governance, AI risk compliance, and GRC specialist roles with US-based organisations, international bodies, or remote-first teams globally.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI Risk Management (NIST AI RMF)	**ISO/IEC 42001:2023 (AI Management)**	**EU AI Act Compliance**
ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Auditor	**Model Risk Assessment**	**AI Policy Development**
Responsible AI Governance	**Algorithmic Bias & Fairness Review**	**AI Incident Management**
GRC Framework Development	**Regulatory Gap Analysis**	**Audit Readiness & Documentation**
GDPR / POPIA Data Governance	**Stakeholder Training & Awareness**	**Research & Thought Leadership**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder and CEO | SentraCore LLC

2025 to Present | Okatie, SC, USA

- Founded and lead a boutique cybersecurity and AI governance consultancy delivering GRC framework development, AI risk management, ISO 27001 implementation support, and compliance readiness services to SMEs across the US and African markets.
- Designed and deployed an original Integrated Management System (IMS) combining ISO/IEC 27001:2022, ISO/IEC 42001:2023, NIST AI RMF 1.0, and POPIA requirements into a single auditable governance structure, eliminating the need for parallel compliance programmes and reducing client administrative overhead.
- Built and launched the SentraCore enterprise platform, including a production AI Governance Module featuring an AI system risk register with tiered risk classification (minimal, limited, high, unacceptable per EU AI Act categories), POPIA compliance flagging, an AI incident timeline, model card generator, and escalation workflows for AI-related risk events.
- Conducted AI risk assessments, control gap analyses, and compliance evaluations for client organisations, translating complex multi-framework regulatory requirements (NIST AI RMF, EU AI Act, ISO 42001) into prioritised, actionable remediation roadmaps.

- Developed and published eight research articles on AI governance, dual-use AI capability, SME compliance frameworks, and the integration of ISO 27001 with emerging AI governance standards, establishing credible thought leadership in the practitioner-researcher space.
- Designed and delivered AI governance and cybersecurity awareness training programmes for non-technical audiences including schools, SMEs, and community organisations, covering responsible AI use, AI risk identification, and regulatory obligations.

Cybersecurity Analyst | CodeAlpha

March 2026 to August 2026 | Remote

- Applied GRC and AI governance knowledge in a live analyst role, conducting threat assessments, vulnerability evaluations, and security incident analysis across assigned cases.
- Produced structured security investigation reports with risk ratings and remediation recommendations, submitted for internal quality review and revised based on feedback.
- Monitored systems for anomalous activity indicators, applied defined investigation frameworks to triage findings, and escalated cases through structured review processes.

AI Data Analyst and Quality Reviewer | Outlier AI (Aether Project)

June 2025 to March 2026 | Remote

- Evaluated large-scale AI model outputs against defined quality rubrics with 98% accuracy, identifying bias indicators, logical inconsistencies, and governance red flags in model responses across text, image, audio, and video modalities.
- Gained direct hands-on experience in AI model lifecycle governance: dataset quality assurance, output evaluation, bias detection and mitigation, and annotation guideline development, all of which inform practical AI risk assessment methodology.
- Provided structured expert feedback to refine model training guidelines, contributing to production AI governance processes at scale.

HSSE Auditor | Various Industrial Organisations

2016 to 2025 | South Africa

- Conducted compliance audits, risk control evaluations, and governance maturity assessments across high-risk industrial environments over a nine-year career, building deep expertise in regulatory compliance, evidence-based reporting, and structured audit methodology.
- Developed audit tools, evidence-based checklists, and governance reporting frameworks deployed across multiple sites and client organisations in mining, construction, and energy sectors.
- Led risk governance training for operational and leadership teams on regulatory obligations, compliance culture, and structured risk management, directly informing current AI governance training delivery methodology.

KEY PROJECTS AND INNOVATIONS

SentraCore Integrated AI Governance Management System | *SentraCore LLC, 2026*

- Designed and implemented a complete integrated management system (IMS) combining ISO/IEC 27001:2022, ISO/IEC 42001:2023, NIST AI RMF 1.0, and POPIA into a single governance framework, eliminating parallel compliance tracks and producing one unified audit evidence set.
- Completed all eight implementation steps through to certification-readiness: scope definition, asset inventory, risk assessment, Statement of Applicability, control implementation, internal audit, management review, and corrective action cycle.

- Framework is currently deployed within SentraCore and forms the basis of client governance engagements, demonstrating practical AI governance implementation beyond theoretical framework knowledge.

SentraCore Platform AI Governance Module | *Production Software, 2026*

- Designed and built a production AI Governance and Model Hub within the SentraCore enterprise platform: AI system register with EU AI Act-aligned risk tier classification, POPIA processing flag, automated review escalation for high-risk systems, AI incident timeline and management workflow, and an automated model card generator producing standardised documentation on company letterhead.
- Platform is live and in active use, providing a practical reference implementation for what AI governance infrastructure looks like at the operational level for an SME.

SME AI Governance Framework | *MSc Research + SentraCore Applied Practice*

- Developed an original conceptual AI governance framework for SMEs integrating ISO 27001, NIST CSF, NIST AI RMF, and ISO/IEC 42001, addressing the documented gap in existing frameworks which assume organisational capabilities SMEs do not have.
- Framework published across multiple research articles and applied in live client engagements, bridging academic governance research with direct commercial implementation.
- Forms the foundation of planned doctoral research: a longitudinal study of AI governance adoption patterns and outcomes in SME environments.

PhishMind AI | *Hackathon Project, 2026* | *github.com/Ch13f007*

- Designed and built an AI-powered adaptive phishing simulation and security awareness platform engineered for African SMEs, with AI-generated personalised simulations by employee role, behavioural risk scoring, and an admin reporting dashboard.
- Demonstrates applied responsible AI governance principles: bias-aware model design, explainable risk scoring, and measurable behavioural improvement output.

Technical Security Labs

- SIEM Analysis (Splunk/Chronicle): threat detection, suspicious activity identification, and structured incident reporting.
- Security Incident Simulation: phishing investigation, digital forensics chain-of-custody documentation, and mitigation strategy development.
- Linux CLI Security Lab: file permission management, system hardening, and security-oriented administration.
- CTF Competitions: active participant, currently ranked 70 points on leaderboard.

PUBLICATIONS — RESEARCHGATE

Chitanda, T. (2026). Integrating ISO/IEC 27001 with Emerging AI Governance Frameworks: Toward a Unified Security and AI Risk Management Model. ResearchGate Preprint.

Chitanda, T. (2026). Same Model, Different Intent: Confronting Dual-Use AI Capability in Cybersecurity Governance. ResearchGate Preprint.

Chitanda, T. (2026). Governing AI in Cybersecurity: Why SMEs Need Integrated Policy Frameworks for AI-Driven Threat Environments. ResearchGate Preprint.

Chitanda, T. (2026). Artificial Intelligence Works Better With Human Intelligence: The Case for Domain-Grounded AI. ResearchGate.

Chitanda, T. (2026). Digital Forensics Readiness in the Age of AI-Driven Cyber Threats: A Governance and Policy Perspective. ResearchGate Preprint.

Chitanda, T. (2026). AI Governance Challenges for Small and Medium Enterprises. ResearchGate.

Chitanda, T. (2026). The Hidden Compliance Gap: Why Small Businesses Fail at Cybersecurity Before They Even Start. ResearchGate.

Chitanda, T. (2026). Do Small and Medium Enterprises Need an AI Safety Officer? ResearchGate.

EDUCATION

MSc Cybersecurity with Artificial Intelligence | University of Central Lancashire

- Admitted via Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) based on 10 years professional experience.
- Research focus: AI governance frameworks, cybersecurity risk management, responsible AI deployment for SMEs.
- Modules include: Cyber Law and Ethics, Digital Forensics, AI for Cybersecurity, Cloud Security, Cybersecurity Strategy, Information Security Management.

Engineering Studies | South Africa

CERTIFICATIONS AND CREDENTIALS

ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Auditor | Mastermind

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate | Coursera / Google

Cybersecurity Management and Leadership | Macquarie University

AI for Cybersecurity | Macquarie University

EC-Council Essentials: Network Defense, Ethical Hacking and Digital Forensics | EC-Council

Computer Networks Security: Scratch to Advanced | EC-Council

Google AI Essentials | Coursera / Google

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner | Udemy

Cyberlaw | Udemy

Complete AI Data Training Course | Udemy

Safety Management Training Course | South Africa

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI Governance Frameworks	NIST AI RMF 1.0, ISO/IEC 42001:2023, EU AI Act, OECD AI Principles, UK AI Safety Framework
Security Frameworks	ISO/IEC 27001:2022, ISO/IEC 27005:2022, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, GDPR, POPIA
Risk and Audit	AI risk assessment, model risk management, gap analysis, Statement of Applicability, internal audit, corrective action
AI and Data	AI model lifecycle governance, dataset quality assurance, bias detection and mitigation, model card development, NLP
Security Operations	SIEM (Splunk, Chronicle), threat detection, vulnerability management, incident response, digital forensics
Technical Tools	Python (fundamentals), SQL, Linux CLI, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office / Excel

Soft Skills	Policy translation, executive communication, cross-functional collaboration, training delivery, research and report writing

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Work authorisation: Employment Authorisation Document (EAD), authorised to work in the United States.
- Available for remote work globally: US, EU, AU, UN agencies, SADC institutions.
- ResearchGate profile: 8 published articles on AI governance, SME cybersecurity, and responsible AI deployment.
- Creator of cybersecurity and AI governance awareness content for non-technical audiences and SME leaders.
- Active contributor to Information Security and AI governance professional communities and forums.
- Languages: English (fluent).